



# India & Spain: Strengthening Partnership, Shaping Shared Growth

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September 2026

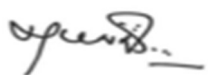
## FOREWORD

Spain occupies a distinctive and increasingly consequential position within Europe's economic landscape. As the European Union's fourth-largest economy and a major gateway between Europe, the Mediterranean and Latin America, Spain combines a diversified industrial base, strong tourism and services sectors, globally competitive automotive and infrastructure capabilities, expanding renewable-energy capacity, and growing strengths in digital technologies, pharmaceuticals and agri-food. Its position within the EU Single Market and its sophisticated infrastructure create substantial long-term potential for international businesses. At the same time, regulatory complexity across European and national frameworks, regional economic differences, evolving labour-market conditions and the competitive nature of the European market shape the pace at which opportunities can be converted into sustained commercial outcomes.

India and Spain share a longstanding diplomatic relationship established in 1956, with economic and strategic engagement gaining renewed momentum in recent years. The year 2026 is being observed as the India–Spain Dual Year of Culture, Tourism and Artificial Intelligence, marking the 70th anniversary of diplomatic relations. President of the Government of Spain Pedro Sánchez's visit to India in February 2026, following his earlier visit in October 2024, further reinforced cooperation across artificial intelligence, manufacturing, defence production, infrastructure, renewable energy, tourism and technology. Bilateral trade has expanded steadily, with Indian exports increasingly encompassing engineering goods, chemicals, pharmaceuticals, textiles and other manufactured products, while Spain remains an important source of machinery, chemicals, transport equipment and other industrial inputs. Investment ties, however, remain capable of expanding considerably relative to the scale and capabilities of both economies.

Looking ahead, the paper outlines a practical set of initiatives through which CCI India can support Indian businesses in engaging with Spain in a manner appropriate to current market conditions whether through sector-specific market intelligence, structured business matchmaking, or institutional dialogue with the Embassy of Spain, ICEX España Exportación e Inversiones, Spanish business associations, regional authorities and other relevant stakeholders that can be scaled as specific opportunities mature. This Knowledge Paper examines, in a structured and evidence-based manner, the current state of Spain's economy, its major sectors, and the opportunities and constraints shaping India–Spain economic engagement, serving as a reference for CCI India's engagement with Spanish institutions, industry stakeholders, investors and Indian companies assessing the market.



  
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Director General  
CCI INDIA

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# SPAIN

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Experience vibrant culture, coastal beauty, and local traditions through slow journeys.



## **Basic Facts and Population**

Spain, officially the Kingdom of Spain, is a major European nation located on the Iberian Peninsula, with Madrid as its capital and largest city. It is a constitutional monarchy with Spanish as the official language, and the national currency being the Euro (EUR).

As of 2025, Spain's population stands at approximately 48.0 million. The country is known for its cultural diversity, historic regions, and strong global cultural influence. The Indian community in Spain continues to grow and contributes meaningfully to bilateral cultural exchanges.

## **Economy and GDP**

Spain is recognized as a high-income, diversified economy within the European Union. Historically reliant on agriculture and manufacturing, the country has successfully transitioned into a service-based economy, with major sectors including tourism, automobile production, renewable energy, finance, and pharmaceuticals. The estimated nominal GDP for 2025 is about US\$ 1.7 trillion, placing Spain among the world's top 15 economies. Its economic strengths are supported by strong infrastructure, innovation in green technologies, and a competitive industrial base.

## **Bilateral Trade and Economic Ties with India**

India and Spain share a steadily expanding partnership rooted in diplomatic ties established in 1956. The relationship covers trade, investment, defense technology, renewable energy cooperation, and growing technological collaboration. Spain supports India's renewable energy and smart-infrastructure initiatives, while India plays a significant role in supplying manufactured goods and IT services to Spain. The two nations continue strengthening cooperation under the broader India-EU strategic engagement framework.



## “ Culture and Heritage

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## Bilateral Trade with India (in Billions)

India–Spain bilateral trade has shown consistent upward momentum, reaching approximately USD 7.2 billion in FY 2024–25. Both countries are working toward diversification of trade through enhanced market access, industrial partnerships, and greater private-sector collaboration. Spain remains one of India’s key economic partners within the European Union, especially in technology, manufacturing, and clean-energy solutions.

## Import and Export from India

The India–Spain trade basket is broad and reflects complementary economic strengths. India’s exports to Spain include textiles, organic chemicals, automobiles, machinery, and pharmaceuticals, while India’s imports from Spain consist mainly of mechanical appliances, electrical machinery, chemicals, plastic goods, and precision instruments. The charts below illustrate the recent five-year trend of bilateral trade flows.

## Culture and Societal Values

India and Spain share warm and evolving cultural ties driven by tourism, cinema collaborations, academic exchanges, yoga adoption, and growing business interactions. The Indian diaspora in Spain, estimated at around 70,000, contributes significantly to entrepreneurship, technology, and hospitality sectors. Spanish interest in Indian culture, festivals, and cuisine has deepened cultural bridges. These people-to-people connections play a central role in strengthening the long-term partnership between the two nations.



## Economic and Investment Ties

Economic ties between India and Spain are reinforced by bilateral investments, joint ventures, and growing cooperation in renewable energy, transportation, defense manufacturing, and technology. Spain is among the largest EU investors in India, particularly in infrastructure and green technologies. Indian investments in Spain continue to expand in IT, chemicals, and industrial manufacturing. The two economies complement one another, enabling sustained expansion in bilateral trade and investment flows.

# 1. COUNTRY PROFILE OF SPAIN

## 1.1 Executive Country Snapshot

|                     |                                                                  |
|---------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Official Name       | Kingdom of Spain (Reino de España)                               |
| Capital             | Madrid                                                           |
| Population          | 48.6 million (2024 est., INE)                                    |
| Geographic Location | Southwestern Europe, Iberian Peninsula                           |
| Currency            | Euro (EUR)                                                       |
| Official Language   | Spanish (Castilian); Co-official: Catalan, Galician, Basque      |
| Political System    | Parliamentary Constitutional Monarchy                            |
| Head of State       | King Felipe VI                                                   |
| Head of Government  | President of the Government (Pedro Sánchez)                      |
| EU Membership       | Since January 1, 1986                                            |
| Major Cities        | Madrid, Barcelona, Valencia, Seville, Zaragoza, Malaga           |
| GDP (Nominal)       | Approx. USD 1.58 Trillion (2023, World Bank)                     |
| GDP per Capita      | Approx. USD 33,000 (2023, World Bank)                            |
| Major Exports       | Cars, Refined Petroleum, Packaged Medicaments, Parts/Accessories |
| Major Imports       | Crude Petroleum, Cars, Petroleum Gas, Packaged Medicaments       |
| Major Ports         | Algeciras, Valencia, Barcelona, Bilbao                           |

## 1.2 Geography and Strategic Location

Spain occupies approximately 85% of the Iberian Peninsula, offering a dual maritime frontage on the Mediterranean Sea and the Atlantic Ocean. This positioning makes Spain a critical logistics hub for three continents: Europe, Africa, and the Americas.

- **Gateway to Latin America:** Due to historical, linguistic, and cultural ties, Spain serves as the primary European entry point for Latin American firms and a launchpad for Indian companies targeting LATAM markets.
- **Proximity to North Africa:** Separated by only 14 km at the Strait of Gibraltar, Spain is a vital partner for trade with Morocco and the wider Maghreb region.
- **Logistics Infrastructure:** Boasting one of the best high-speed rail networks (AVE) in the world and world-class ports (Valencia and Algeciras), Spain offers seamless connectivity to the rest of the EU.

## 1.3 Political and Administrative Structure

Spain is a highly decentralized state divided into 17 Autonomous Communities (Comunidades Autónomas) and 2 Autonomous Cities (Ceuta and Melilla). Each region has significant competencies in economic promotion, education, and health, which is crucial for Indian businesses to understand.

| Region         | Business Relevance for India                                                  |
|----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Madrid         | Financial center, corporate HQs, aerospace, and high-tech services.           |
| Catalonia      | Industrial powerhouse, chemicals, automotive, and logistics (Barcelona port). |
| Basque Country | Advanced manufacturing, energy, and automotive components.                    |

## 1.4 Demographics and Society

Spain's demographic profile is characterized by an aging population, which drives demand in healthcare and biotechnology sectors where India has significant strength. Furthermore, Spain's high urbanization rate (approx. 81%) and digital literacy create a ready market for Indian IT and fintech solutions.

## 1.5 Spain's Global Position

As a member of the G20 (permanent guest), EU, and OECD, Spain is a middle power with a high degree of international integration. It is a top-15 global economy and a leader in tourism and renewable energy (specifically wind and solar). For CCI India, Spain represents a stable, rules-based environment that facilitates long-term investment cycles.

## 2. SPAIN'S ECONOMIC LANDSCAPE

### 2.1 Macroeconomic Overview

Spain represents the fourth-largest economy in the Eurozone and the 14th largest globally by nominal GDP. Following a robust recovery post-pandemic, the Spanish economy has shown resilience, often outperforming the EU average growth rates in 2023 and 2024. Key pillars of the economy include a strong service sector, diversified manufacturing, and a world-leading renewable energy infrastructure.

| Indicator          | Value (2023/24)      | Source              |
|--------------------|----------------------|---------------------|
| GDP Growth         | 2.5% (2023 Actual)   | IMF / Bank of Spain |
| Inflation (HICP)   | 3.4% (Avg 2023)      | Eurostat            |
| Unemployment Rate  | 11.7% (Q4 2023)      | INE Spain           |
| Public Debt to GDP | 107.7%               | Bank of Spain       |
| Budget Deficit     | 3.7% of GDP          | Ministry of Economy |
| FDI Inflow         | €34.1 Billion (2023) | DataInvex           |

### 2.2 Major Economic Sectors

- **Renewable Energy:** Spain is a global leader in wind and solar power. Companies like Iberdrola and Acciona are world-class players. Opportunity: Indian-Spanish joint ventures in Green Hydrogen and offshore wind.
- **Automotive:** Spain is the 2nd largest car producer in Europe. Key focus is transitioning to Electric Vehicles (EVs). Opportunity: Battery supply chain and component manufacturing for Indian Tier-1 suppliers.
- **Tourism & Hospitality:** Contributing ~12% to GDP. Spain is consistently in the top 3 most visited countries. Opportunity: Investment in hotel tech and luxury hospitality assets.
- **Pharmaceuticals & Biotech:** Strong R&D hubs in Barcelona and Madrid. Opportunity: Indian API manufacturers and clinical research collaboration.

- **Agri-Food & Processing:** The 'Garden of Europe'. Leader in olive oil, wine, and pork. Opportunity: Technology exchange in cold chain and sustainable irrigation.
- **Digital Economy & Startups:** Rapidly growing hubs in Valencia and Malaga (Malaga TechPark). Opportunity: IT services, AI, and cybersecurity services from India.

## 2.3 Major Spanish Companies (Strategic Stakeholders)

| Company        | Sector          | Relevance to India                                             |
|----------------|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Inditex (Zara) | Textiles/Retail | Major sourcing from India; massive retail footprint.           |
| Iberdrola      | Energy          | Potential partner for India's National Green Hydrogen Mission. |
| Navantia       | Defense/Naval   | Collaborating on submarine and naval projects (P75I).          |
| Gestamp        | Automotive      | Already has multiple plants in India; key component partner.   |
| Amadeus        | Travel Tech     | Massive R&D center in Bengaluru; backbone of travel industry.  |

## 3. INDIA–SPAIN DIPLOMATIC RELATIONS

Diplomatic relations between India and Spain were established in 1956. Over the decades, the relationship has matured into a 'Strategic Partnership' with a strong focus on economic and security cooperation. High-level visits, including PM Modi's visit to Spain in 2017 and President Pedro Sánchez's scheduled engagements, have provided the political impetus needed for trade expansion.

### Key Milestones in India-Spain Relations

- 1956: Establishment of diplomatic ties.
- 1988: Visit of PM Rajiv Gandhi to Spain.
- 2017: PM Narendra Modi's landmark visit to Madrid (First in 30 years).
- 2021: Agreement on the manufacture of C-295 transport aircraft in India (Airbus & Tata).
- 2023: G20 Summit in New Delhi - High-level bilateral talks on trade and defense.
- 2024: Spain PM Pedro Sanchez visited India and jointly inaugurate the C-295 aircraft
- 2025: Indian External Affairs Minister Dr. S. Jaishankar Visited Spain to meet leadership, advancing cooperative agreements in sports & urban development.
- 2026: Spain Foreign Minister Joce Maruel Albares, inaugurated the Commemorative logo for the 70<sup>th</sup> anniversary and announced Spain joins Indo-Pacific Oceans Initiative.

### 3.1 Embassies and Commercial Offices

The Embassy of India in Madrid and the Embassy of Spain in New Delhi (along with Consulates in Mumbai) act as the primary facilitators. The Economic and Commercial Office of Spain (ICEX) in India plays a critical role in supporting Spanish SMEs entering the Indian market.

## 4. INDIA–SPAIN TRADE RELATIONS

### 4.1 Bilateral Trade Overview and Trends

Bilateral trade between India and Spain has crossed the USD 8 billion mark, showing a consistent upward trajectory despite global supply chain disruptions. India maintains a healthy trade surplus with Spain, driven largely by exports in textiles, chemicals, and engineering goods.

| Year       | India Exports to Spain (USD Bn) | India Imports from Spain (USD Bn) | Total Trade (USD Bn) |
|------------|---------------------------------|-----------------------------------|----------------------|
| 2019       | 4.52                            | 1.78                              | 6.30                 |
| 2020       | 3.60                            | 1.35                              | 4.95                 |
| 2021       | 5.10                            | 1.92                              | 7.02                 |
| 2022       | 6.20                            | 2.10                              | 8.30                 |
| 2023 (Est) | 6.55                            | 2.25                              | 8.80                 |

### 4.2 Major Indian Exports to Spain

Indian exports are diversified but concentrated in value-added manufacturing and raw materials. The following product categories dominate the export basket:

- **Textiles and Apparel:** Finished garments, cotton yarn, and home textiles (Major suppliers to Inditex/Mango).
- **Chemicals and Pharmaceuticals:** Organic chemicals and Active Pharmaceutical Ingredients (APIs).
- **Engineering Goods:** Iron and steel products, auto components, and industrial machinery.
- **Leather Products:** Footwear and luxury leather accessories.
- **Marine Products:** Frozen shrimp and squid (Spain is a massive seafood consumer).

### 4.3 Major Spanish Exports to India

- **Machinery and Equipment:** High-precision tools and industrial automation.
- **Inorganic Chemicals:** Specific chemical compounds for Indian industrial processes.
- **Plastics and Rubber:** Advanced polymer products for the automotive sector.
- **Defense Equipment:** Aviation components and naval technology.
- **Olive Oil and Wines:** Premium consumer goods targeting India's growing middle class.

### 4.4 High-Potential Product Opportunities for Indian Businesses

Based on Spanish market demand and Indian manufacturing competitiveness, India identifies the following 'Sunrise' products for market entry and expansion:

| Product Category      | Why Spain?                          | Indian Capability                      |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| Green Hydrogen Tech   | Spain aims to be EU's Hydrogen hub. | Low-cost electrolyzer assembly.        |
| EV Components         | Spanish 'PERTE' program for EVs.    | Strong auto-ancillary ecosystem.       |
| Organic Agri-Products | High demand for bio-foods in EU.    | Increasing organic certification base. |
| IT & SaaS             | Spanish SMEs digitizing rapidly.    | Scalable software solutions.           |
| Sustainable Fashion   | EU ESG regulations tightening.      | Recycled polyester & organic cotton.   |

### 4.5 Bilateral Investment Relations

Spanish FDI in India is significant, with over 250 Spanish companies having a presence. Conversely, Indian firms like Tata, Mahindra, and Infosys have established beachheads in Spain to serve the European market.

## 5. MAJOR CHALLENGES FACING SPAIN

To identify genuine commercial opportunities, it is essential to understand the structural and economic hurdles currently facing the Spanish market. These challenges represent “pain points” where Indian solutions, services, and partnerships can provide significant value. Addressing these gaps can create new avenues for trade, investment, technology transfer, and long-term business collaboration between India and Spain. A clear understanding of these challenges also enables Indian businesses to develop more targeted and competitive market-entry strategies.

## 5.1 The Opportunity Matrix: Solving Spanish Challenges

| Spain's Challenge              | Why It Matters                                                                                 | Indian Opportunity                                                              | CCI India Response                                                        |
|--------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Energy Transition & High Costs | Dependence on external natural gas; urgent need to decarbonize industrial sectors.             | Indian expertise in large-scale solar commissioning and Green Hydrogen storage. | CCI India to host an 'India-Spain Green Energy Summit' for tech-transfer. |
| Labor Shortages in Tech        | Rapid digital transformation causing a deficit of AI, Cloud, and Cybersecurity experts.        | Indian IT firms and SaaS startups providing remote/on-site digital talent.      | Establishing a 'Digital Bridge' program for recruitment and outsourcing.  |
| Water Scarcity & Management    | Severe droughts affecting the massive agricultural sector in Andalusia and Murcia.             | Indian ag-tech solutions in precision irrigation and wastewater treatment.      | Agri-tech delegation focused on sustainable water management systems.     |
| Aging Infrastructure in SMEs   | Small and Medium Enterprises (98% of businesses) need Industry 4.0 modernization.              | Affordable automation and IoT sensors manufactured in India.                    | B2B matchmaking for industrial automation and machinery exports.          |
| Geographic De-risking          | Spanish firms looking to move supply chains away from high-dependency on single Asian markets. | India as the primary 'China Plus One' partner for Spanish manufacturing.        | Investment roadshows promoting 'Make in India' to Spanish conglomerates.  |

## 6. HOW CCI INDIA CAN CONTRIBUTE

As a leading industry body, CCI India is well positioned to act as an institutional catalyst for strengthening India–Spain commercial and economic relations. Its role can extend beyond providing information to actively facilitating market access, connecting businesses, supporting investment and creating long-term institutional relationships. By combining market intelligence, sector expertise, business matchmaking, delegations, regulatory orientation and stakeholder engagement, CCI India can help Indian companies better understand the Spanish market while also creating opportunities for Spanish companies to engage with India's rapidly expanding business ecosystem.

In the renewable energy sector, CCI India can function as a knowledge and business facilitation platform by providing Indian companies with information on Spain's renewable-energy ecosystem, investment environment, project opportunities and relevant regulatory requirements. CCI India could organise focused business webinars and knowledge sessions covering solar energy, wind power, green hydrogen, energy storage and other clean technologies. These activities can help Indian companies identify Spanish partners, technology providers and investors and gradually develop opportunities for joint projects, technology partnerships and investment. CCI India can further facilitate introductions between project developers, technology companies, financial institutions and government-linked stakeholders to help convert discussions into commercially viable opportunities.

In the automotive and advanced manufacturing sector, CCI India can take a delegation-leadership role by organising focused business missions connecting Indian automotive manufacturers, component suppliers, EV companies and technology firms with Spanish manufacturers, engineering companies and industrial clusters. Visits to important automotive ecosystems, including the Basque Country and other industrial regions, can provide Indian businesses with exposure to advanced manufacturing practices and potential supply-chain partners. The longer-term objective should be to develop supplier relationships, technology partnerships, manufacturing cooperation and potential joint ventures. CCI India can also facilitate structured B2B meetings with potential buyers, component manufacturers, technology providers and industrial investors based on clearly defined business requirements. Such engagement can help Indian companies understand European quality standards, manufacturing expectations and supply-chain requirements while identifying practical opportunities for collaboration and investment.

For the textile and fashion sector, CCI India can act as a market facilitator by helping Indian textile manufacturers, exporters and fashion businesses understand Spanish market requirements and identify potential buyers, distributors and strategic partners. Targeted B2B engagements with major Spanish fashion and retail companies, where commercially appropriate, along with participation in relevant trade events, can provide Indian businesses with greater exposure to the Spanish market.

In food processing and agriculture, CCI India can serve as a trade bridge between Indian producers and Spanish importers, distributors, retailers and food-processing companies. Participation in major Spanish and European food exhibitions, including relevant events in Barcelona, can create opportunities for Indian businesses in spices, processed foods, tea, agricultural products and other food categories. CCI India can support participating companies with buyer identification, market information, product requirements and B2B meetings, helping Indian food businesses move from market exploration towards actual commercial relationships and market entry.

In the startup and technology ecosystem, CCI India can act as an ecosystem link connecting Indian startups with Spanish startups, corporations, investors, universities, accelerators and innovation institutions. An India–Spain Startup Pitch Day could provide a structured platform for selected companies to showcase technologies, identify commercial partners and explore investment opportunities. Priority areas could include artificial intelligence, clean technology, climate technology, AgTech, FinTech, logistics technology, industrial technology and EV-related solutions. Over time, this cooperation could support cross-border investment, technology partnerships, pilot projects and joint innovation.

## 7. STAKEHOLDER LANDSCAPE

### 7.1 Stakeholder Priority Matrix

| Stakeholder                  | Country | Sector         | Role                 | Priority |
|------------------------------|---------|----------------|----------------------|----------|
| Ministry of External Affairs | India   | Government     | Diplomatic Support   | High     |
| ICEX Spain Export & Inv.     | Spain   | Trade          | FDI Facilitation     | High     |
| Invest India                 | India   | Investment     | Business Matchmaking | High     |
| CEOE (Business Confed.)      | Spain   | Chamber        | Policy Advocacy      | High     |
| ACCIÓ (Catalonia)            | Spain   | Regional Trade | Tech Partnership     | Medium   |

## 8. BUSINESS DELEGATION OPPORTUNITIES

**Theme:** Manufacturing & Industry 4.0 Mission

**Target Region:** Bilbao & Barcelona

**Objective:** To visit advanced automotive clusters and discuss assembly JVs.

**Expected Outcome:** MoUs between Indian auto-ancillaries and Spanish tech providers.

**Theme:** Agri-Tech & Water Management Mission

**Target Region:** Seville & Murcia

**Objective:** Exposure to high-tech irrigation and greenhouse farming techniques.

**Expected Outcome:** Introduction of Spanish micro-irrigation tech to Indian farmers via CCI.

**Theme:** Renewable Energy & Green Hydrogen Expo

**Target Region:** Madrid

**Objective:** Attend 'Genera' (Energy Trade Fair) and meet EPC contractors.

**Expected Outcome:** Collaboration on upcoming solar park bids in India.

## 9. STARTUP & SME COOPERATION

Spain has a vibrant startup ecosystem, particularly in Barcelona (21@ district) and Madrid. Indian startups in SaaS, AI, and Fintech can utilize Spain as a 'Soft Landing' pad for the EU. India proposes an 'India-Spain Startup Bridge' to facilitate exchange programs and mentorship.

## 10. SWOT ANALYSIS

**Strengths:** India and Spain have several complementary strengths that can support deeper economic and business cooperation. India offers a large and skilled talent pool, a growing manufacturing base, strong digital capabilities and a rapidly expanding domestic market. Spain provides strategic access to the European market through its EU membership, along with strong infrastructure, industrial capabilities and geographic connectivity with Latin America. Cultural and historical linkages, combined with growing institutional engagement, can further support business relationships between the two countries.

**Weaknesses:** Smaller Indian companies may face challenges when entering the Spanish market, particularly because of language differences and the need to understand local business practices. Compliance with EU regulations, employment requirements and administrative procedures can also increase the complexity of market entry. Geographic distance between India and Spain may create additional logistics, transportation and supply-chain costs, especially for businesses dealing with time-sensitive or high-volume products.

**Opportunities:** The India–Spain relationship presents significant opportunities across emerging and strategic sectors. Defence and aerospace manufacturing, including cooperation associated with the C-295 programme, can create opportunities for industrial partnerships, component manufacturing and technology collaboration. Green hydrogen, renewable energy, energy storage and clean technologies offer another major area for cooperation. Spain's industrial and technological capabilities can also complement India's growing manufacturing and digital ecosystem. In addition, Indian technology companies can support the digital transformation of Spanish SMEs by providing cost-effective technology, software, AI and digital business solutions.

**Threats:** Indian businesses entering Spain will face competition from established European suppliers as well as emerging manufacturing locations in Eastern Europe, which may offer proximity to major European markets and competitive operating costs. Slower economic growth or prolonged economic stagnation in parts of the European Union could affect investment and consumer demand. In addition, changes in EU regulations related to data privacy, sustainability, product standards, employment and other compliance requirements could increase the cost and complexity of doing business. These risks highlight the importance of continuous market intelligence, regulatory monitoring and strong local partnerships for successful India–Spain business cooperation.

## 11. MARKET ENTRY CONSIDERATIONS

Entering the Spanish market requires Indian companies to consider not only commercial demand but also language, corporate structure, EU regulations, taxation, regional business ecosystems and available investment-support programmes.

### 11.1 Language & Business Communication

Spanish is the principal language for government, legal, regulatory and many local business interactions. English is widely used in international business, particularly among multinational companies and larger professional organisations. However, Indian companies should consider Spanish-language documentation and local professional support when dealing with government authorities, contracts, licences, employment matters and regulatory procedures.

### 11.2 Legal Entity & Local Presence

An Indian company entering Spain can choose among several structures depending on its commercial objectives, including establishing a subsidiary, branch, representative presence or operating through a local partner/distributor.

The Sociedad Limitada (S.L.), broadly comparable to a private limited-liability company, is a common corporate form for privately held businesses. However, the appropriate structure should be selected according to investment size, tax position, liability, ownership, operational requirements and the company's long-term European strategy. Indian companies should also evaluate the regulatory and administrative obligations associated with establishing and operating a Spanish entity. Professional legal, tax and accounting advice is advisable to ensure that the chosen structure aligns with both Spanish regulations and the company's broader business objectives.

### 11.3 EU Product Standards & Regulatory Compliance

Indian exporters must assess European Union product requirements before entering Spain because Spain is part of the EU Single Market.

Depending on the product, requirements may include:

- CE marking
- product safety requirements
- technical documentation
- conformity assessment
- labelling requirements
- environmental regulations
- chemical regulations
- packaging requirements
- food-safety requirements
- product-specific EU standards

CE marking is not a universal requirement for every product. It applies to product categories covered by specific EU harmonisation legislation.

Similarly, REACH is particularly relevant to chemicals and products containing substances regulated under EU chemicals legislation. Companies should therefore conduct a product-specific compliance assessment rather than assuming that CE marking or REACH applies to every export.

### 11.4 Regional Incentives & Investment Support

Spain's autonomous communities operate a range of investment, employment, industrial, energy, innovation and business-support programmes. The availability, eligibility and value of incentives depend on the project, sector, company size, location and applicable funding programme.

**Andalusia**, for example, currently operates programmes supporting industrial development, SME growth, new business establishments, energy-related investment and R&D. In 2026, Andalusia announced substantial R&D incentive programmes and has also issued support for industrial and agro-food investment.

Therefore, Indian companies should assess regional incentives before selecting the location of an investment, rather than assuming that the same support is available throughout Spain.

Potentially relevant regions may include:

- Andalusia

- Extremadura
- Valencia
- Galicia
- Castilla-La Mancha
- Castilla y León
- Aragón
- Basque Country
- other regions depending on the investment project

## 11.5 Customs & EU Market Access

Spain provides access to the EU Single Market, but Indian companies must comply with applicable EU customs, import, product, taxation and regulatory requirements.

Companies should evaluate:

- HS classification
- customs duties
- rules of origin
- import documentation
- VAT
- product-specific regulations
- labelling
- packaging
- importer responsibilities
- logistics costs
- EU sustainability requirements

The Spanish government also maintains information on business establishment procedures, licences and administrative requirements through its official business-services portal.

## 11.6 Regional Market Strategy

A company should identify the Spanish region that best matches its sector and business model. Regional differences in industrial strengths, infrastructure, consumer preferences, business networks and investment incentives can significantly influence market-entry outcomes. Regions such as Catalonia, the Basque Country, Madrid, Andalusia and Valencia offer distinct commercial ecosystems and sectoral advantages. Understanding these regional characteristics can help Indian companies identify the most suitable partners, customers and investment opportunities. A region-specific approach can therefore make market entry more focused, cost-effective and commercially sustainable.

| Region                | Potential Relevance                                                               |
|-----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Madrid                | Government, finance, professional services, technology and corporate headquarters |
| Catalonia / Barcelona | Technology, manufacturing, automotive, logistics, tourism and startups            |
| Valencia              | Ports, logistics, agriculture, food processing and manufacturing                  |
| Andalusia             | Agriculture, tourism, renewable energy, aerospace and industrial development      |
| Basque Country        | Advanced manufacturing, engineering, energy and industrial technology             |
| Galicia               | Seafood, food, maritime industries and selected manufacturing                     |
| Aragón                | Logistics, automotive and industrial supply chains                                |
| Extremadura           | Agriculture, renewable energy and regional investment opportunities               |

## 11.7 Recommended Market-Entry Approach for Indian Companies

A practical India-to-Spain market-entry process can follow:

Market Research → Product Compliance → Regional Selection → Local Partner Identification → Legal Structure → Pilot Entry → B2B Development → Scale-up

Indian companies should avoid entering Spain solely through a broad “Europe strategy”. A more effective approach is to identify:

Product → Target Customer → Spanish Region → Regulatory Requirements → Local Partner → Distribution Channel → Expansion Plan

## 12. STRATEGIC RECOMMENDATIONS

The India–Spain relationship has the potential to develop from a conventional bilateral trade relationship into a broader platform for trade, investment, technology transfer, industrial cooperation, innovation, SME development and market access. CCI India can contribute by creating practical mechanisms that connect businesses, institutions, investors and policymakers in both countries.

The recommendations below are structured across short-, medium- and long-term horizons. The approach is designed to move from institutional groundwork and market intelligence toward sustained business engagement, investment facilitation and long-term economic cooperation.

## 12.1 SHORT-TERM RECOMMENDATIONS

### **Build the Institutional Foundation - Establish a Dedicated “India Spain Desk”**

India should establish a dedicated Spain Desk as the primary point of contact for Indian companies interested in Spain.

The Spain Desk could provide:

- Spain market intelligence
- sector-specific business information
- trade inquiries
- Spanish buyer identification
- distributor and partner identification
- regulatory orientation
- investment information
- government and institutional contacts
- delegation support
- B2B matchmaking
- post-meeting follow-up

The Desk should maintain a structured database of Indian companies seeking Spanish partnerships and Spanish organisations seeking Indian suppliers, investors or technology partners.

**Expected outcome:** Creation of a permanent institutional channel for India–Spain business enquiries.

#### **12.1.1 Develop an India–Spain Business Intelligence Database**

Create a continuously updated database covering:

- Spanish companies
- Indian companies active in Spain
- importers
- exporters
- distributors
- investors
- industry associations
- chambers
- startups
- universities

- research organisations
- government agencies
- sector-specific institutions

The database should classify organisations by sector, location, company size and potential cooperation area.

**Expected outcome:** Faster and more targeted business matchmaking.

### 12.1.2 Establish Institutional Partnerships with Spanish Chambers

India should initiate discussions with relevant Spanish chambers and regional business organisations, particularly in commercially important regions such as:

- Catalonia
- Basque Country
- Valencia
- Madrid
- Andalusia
- Galicia

Potential cooperation areas should include:

- exchange of business delegations
- joint business forums
- SME matchmaking
- market intelligence
- investment promotion
- startup cooperation
- sector-specific events

Where appropriate, India can pursue formal MoUs or cooperation agreements after institutional due diligence. Such partnerships can create a structured channel for regular business-to-business engagement and improve access to regional decision-makers, industry networks and potential investors. They can also support long-term collaboration in priority sectors and strengthen the institutional foundation of India–Spain economic relations. Regional partnerships can further help Indian MSMEs identify local market opportunities, understand regulatory expectations and establish trusted commercial contacts. Over time, these institutional linkages can evolve into a wider network supporting trade, investment, innovation and joint ventures between businesses in both countries.

### 12.1.3 Organise a High-Level India–Spain Business Webinar

India should organise a flagship virtual programme involving:

- Indian diplomatic representatives
- Spanish diplomatic representatives
- government officials
- chambers of commerce
- industry associations
- Indian exporters
- Spanish importers
- investors
- technology companies

Theme: “India–Spain: Building the Next Generation of Trade, Investment & Industrial Partnerships”. The event should not be limited to speeches. It should conclude with a structured business-interest registration process.

**Expected outcome:** Identification of companies and sectors for subsequent B2B engagement.

### 12.1.4 Conduct an Indian MSME Spain-Market Barrier Survey

India should conduct a structured survey of Indian MSMEs interested in Spain.

The survey should identify barriers related to:

- product certification
- EU regulations
- language
- customs
- logistics
- pricing
- distribution
- finding buyers
- payment terms
- taxation
- intellectual property
- market knowledge
- local representation

The results should be converted into a “Spain Market Entry Barrier Report for Indian MSMEs.”

**Expected outcome:** Evidence-based design of future CCI India support programmes.

### 12.1.5 Launch an “Export to Spain Readiness Programme”

The programme can begin with Understanding Spain, giving participating companies an overview of Spain’s economy, major industries, regional business hubs, consumer preferences, business environment and commercial opportunities. This can be followed by EU Market Requirements, where companies can learn about the broader European Union market framework, import procedures, applicable regulations, documentation and other requirements that may affect their products when entering Spain.

A dedicated Product Compliance module should help businesses understand the regulatory and technical requirements applicable to their specific products. Depending on the product category, this may include conformity assessment, product standards, safety requirements, CE marking where applicable, environmental requirements and other relevant EU regulations. The Packaging and Labelling module should then focus on practical requirements relating to packaging, product information, labelling, language, consumer information and other market-specific considerations that exporters need to address before shipping products to Spain.

The programme should also include a Finding Spanish Buyers module that explains how Indian companies can identify and approach suitable importers, distributors, wholesalers, retailers, institutional buyers and strategic partners in Spain.

This could include guidance on market research, buyer profiling, business directories, trade fairs, chambers of commerce, B2B platforms and structured business matchmaking. The Pricing and Logistics module should help exporters understand how to develop competitive export pricing while considering production costs, freight, insurance, customs-related costs, taxes, distribution margins, warehousing and delivery timelines. Participants should also be introduced to appropriate logistics and shipping considerations for their product categories.

Since successful international business depends not only on products and pricing but also on effective communication, the programme should include a Business Culture module covering Spanish business etiquette, communication styles, relationship building, meeting practices, decision-making processes and other cultural factors that can influence commercial relationships. The B2B Negotiation module can then prepare companies for discussions with Spanish buyers and partners, including presentation of products, commercial terms, payment conditions, delivery schedules, distribution arrangements, contract discussions and long-term partnership development.

Finally, the programme should provide Post-Export Support so that companies are not left without assistance after completing their first transaction. India can support participating businesses with follow-up communication, buyer relationship management, issue escalation, additional business introductions, repeat-order opportunities and identification of new market opportunities.

Through this end-to-end approach, the Export to Spain Readiness Programme can become a practical export-support mechanism that moves Indian companies from market awareness to actual commercial engagement and long-term participation in the Spanish and wider European markets.

#### **12.1.6 Identify Priority Sectors for India–Spain Cooperation**

India could initially focus resources on a limited number of high-potential sectors rather than attempting to cover every industry simultaneously.

Recommended priority sectors:

- Renewable Energy
- Automotive & EV Components
- Food Processing & Agriculture
- Engineering & Manufacturing
- Pharmaceuticals & Healthcare
- IT & Digital Technology
- Aerospace
- Logistics
- Textiles & Fashion
- Startups & Innovation

Each sector should have its own opportunity map and stakeholder database.

#### **12.1.7 Create a Spain Regional Opportunity Map**

India could develop a comprehensive Spain Regional Opportunity Map that provides Indian businesses with a clear, region-wise understanding of Spain's commercial and investment landscape. The guide should connect each region with its major industries, leading companies, logistics and industrial infrastructure, available investment incentives and the potential opportunities for Indian businesses. By bringing these factors together in one structured resource, India can make it easier for companies to identify regions that align with their specific products, operational requirements, supply-chain needs and expansion plans.

The Regional Opportunity Map should function as a practical location-selection and market-entry tool, enabling Indian companies to compare Spanish regions before making investment or partnership decisions. For example, a manufacturing company may prioritise regions with established industrial clusters and logistics infrastructure, while a technology company may focus on areas with strong innovation ecosystems and skilled talent.

Similarly, companies seeking renewable energy, food processing, automotive, aerospace or logistics opportunities can identify regions where relevant capabilities and incentives are concentrated. This initiative would allow CCI India to provide more targeted market-entry support by connecting

**Region → Industry → Companies → Infrastructure → Incentives → Potential Indian Opportunity.**

### 12.1.8 Establish a Spanish Business Advisory Network

India could establish a Spanish Business Advisory Network comprising a carefully vetted group of professional service providers in Spain who can support Indian companies with the practical requirements of entering and operating in the Spanish market. The network can cover key areas such as corporate law, taxation, accounting, customs, immigration, intellectual property, product compliance, logistics, recruitment and commercial real estate. By connecting Indian businesses with reliable local professionals, India can help companies access specialised expertise and better understand the legal, regulatory and operational environment before establishing business activities in Spain.

India should primarily function as a facilitator and connector rather than directly providing regulated professional advice. The network should focus on identifying credible professionals, making appropriate introductions and helping businesses understand which type of specialist support they may require.

This approach would create a trusted support ecosystem for Indian companies while ensuring that legal, tax, compliance and other regulated matters are handled by appropriately qualified professionals in Spain. Over time, the network could become an important component of India's broader India–Spain Market Entry and Business Facilitation Platform.

### 12.1.9 Create an India–Spain Business Opportunity Bulletin

India could develop a quarterly India–Spain Business Opportunity Bulletin as a regular digital information product of the India Spain Desk. The bulletin can provide Indian businesses with a consolidated view of emerging commercial opportunities in Spain, including new business opportunities, public and private tenders, investment opportunities, upcoming trade fairs, sector developments and relevant market trends. By bringing this information together in a structured and accessible format, the bulletin can help Indian companies identify opportunities that may otherwise be difficult to track across multiple sources.

The bulletin should also highlight regulatory changes, Spanish buyer requirements, Indian export opportunities and upcoming business delegations, with information organised according to priority sectors and business relevance. Where appropriate, it can include brief market insights, links to relevant institutions, deadlines, participation details and guidance on how companies can express their interest. This would make the bulletin more than a general newsletter and position it as a practical business intelligence tool for companies exploring the Spanish market.

Over time, the India–Spain Business Opportunity Bulletin could become a recurring information service of the India Spain Desk, supporting continuous engagement between Indian and Spanish businesses. It can also serve as a channel through which India communicates upcoming B2B programmes, delegation opportunities, sector-specific initiatives and market-entry support, thereby creating a regular flow of information and business leads throughout the year.

## 12.2 MEDIUM-TERM RECOMMENDATIONS

### 1–3 Years Build Commercial Infrastructure

Develop a dedicated “India–Spain SME Connect” digital matchmaking platform to connect verified small and medium-sized enterprises from India and Spain and facilitate practical business collaboration. The platform can provide companies with structured profiles covering their business activities, product categories, capabilities and areas of interest, while allowing buyers to communicate their sourcing requirements and suppliers to showcase relevant products and services. It can also facilitate partnership requests, investment opportunities, technology requirements and direct B2B meeting requests, creating a single digital ecosystem for bilateral SME engagement.

To maintain the quality and credibility of the platform, India should introduce a verification mechanism for participating companies and enquiries. Basic business credentials and relevant company information can be verified before profiles are made fully active, helping reduce low-quality, misleading or potentially fraudulent enquiries. The platform can also use sector-wise categorisation and matching tools to connect companies based on products, business requirements, geography and partnership interests.

The long-term objective should be to build a substantial verified India–Spain SME network within the first three years, creating a reliable pipeline of businesses for B2B meetings, trade delegations, sourcing partnerships, investment discussions and technology collaboration. As the network grows, the platform could become one of the core digital components of India’s broader India–Spain Business Cooperation Platform, providing continuous business matchmaking beyond physical events and delegations.

### 12.2.1 Organise Two Major Business Delegations Every Year

Organise at least two structured India–Spain business delegations annually, with each delegation focused on a high-potential sector and designed to generate measurable commercial outcomes. Rather than functioning solely as promotional visits, these delegations should bring together relevant Indian companies, Spanish businesses, government representatives, industry associations, investors and technology providers. A sector-focused approach would allow participants to engage with the right stakeholders and explore specific opportunities for trade, investment, technology cooperation and long-term partnerships.

The first delegation could focus on Renewable Energy and Green Technology, covering areas such as solar and wind energy, energy storage, green hydrogen, energy efficiency, smart-grid solutions and other clean technologies. The delegation could connect Indian companies and project developers with Spanish technology providers, manufacturers, investors and energy-sector organisations, creating opportunities for technology partnerships, project collaboration, equipment sourcing, investment and joint ventures. The programme could also explore Spain's experience in renewable-energy deployment and identify solutions that could be adapted or scaled in the Indian market. It could further include visits to renewable-energy projects, technology centres and industrial facilities to provide Indian participants with practical exposure to Spanish capabilities. Dedicated investor–company meetings could also help identify potential financing, technology-transfer and co-development opportunities. The second delegation could focus on Automotive, EV and Advanced Manufacturing, with particular attention to EV components, batteries, automotive electronics, automotive software, manufacturing technologies, industrial automation and supply-chain partnerships. This delegation could bring together Indian automotive and technology companies with Spanish manufacturers, component suppliers, engineering firms and technology providers. The objective would be to identify opportunities for supplier relationships, technology transfer, manufacturing partnerships, joint ventures and integration into international automotive and EV supply chains.

Each delegation should follow a structured engagement model covering Government Meetings → Industry Meetings → B2B Meetings → Factory Visits → Investment Meetings → Follow-up Programme. Government and institutional meetings can provide policy and market context, while industry and B2B sessions can focus directly on commercial opportunities. Factory and facility visits can provide practical understanding of Spanish technologies and production capabilities, while investment meetings can explore potential projects and partnerships. Most importantly, CCI India should establish a post-delegation follow-up mechanism to track business leads, meetings, partnership discussions, investment proposals and transactions emerging from each delegation, ensuring that the programme produces sustained outcomes beyond the initial visit.

### 12.2.2 Establish an India–Spain Investment Facilitation Programme

Create a dedicated India–Spain Investment Facilitation Programme to support two-way investment and help businesses identify, evaluate and pursue investment opportunities in both markets. The programme could assist companies with investment opportunity identification, project screening, potential partner identification, investor introductions, regional location information and regulatory orientation. It could also support business delegations, site visits and institutional meetings, followed by structured post-investment networking to help investors build relationships within the local business ecosystem.

The programme should adopt a two-way investment approach, supporting both Spanish investment into India and Indian investment into Spain. By creating a structured bridge between investors, companies, institutions and potential projects, India can help reduce information gaps and facilitate stronger investment relationships. Over time, the programme could become an important component of India's broader India–Spain Business Cooperation Platform, supporting not only initial investor introductions but also long-term investment partnerships, joint ventures and business expansion.

### 12.2.3. Develop an India–Spain Startup Bridge

Establish an India–Spain Startup Bridge as a dedicated cooperation programme to connect emerging companies, founders, investors, technology providers and innovation institutions from both countries. The programme could initially focus on high-growth and strategically important areas such as Artificial Intelligence, AgTech, ClimateTech, CleanTech, FinTech, HealthTech, Industrial Technology, Logistics Technology and EV Technology. By bringing together startups working on complementary technologies and market solutions, the initiative could create opportunities for cross-border collaboration, technology partnerships and access to new markets.

The programme could include structured startup exchanges, founder meetings, investor introductions, accelerator partnerships and technology demonstrations, allowing Indian and Spanish startups to understand each other's capabilities and identify potential areas of cooperation. India could also facilitate curated business meetings between startups and established companies looking for innovative solutions, helping promising technologies move from initial discussions towards commercial opportunities.

A further focus should be on pilot projects and soft-landing support, enabling selected startups to test their products, technologies or business models in the partner country with appropriate local guidance. Soft-landing support could include market orientation, introductions to local partners, ecosystem access and assistance in understanding the business environment.

Over time, the India–Spain Startup Bridge could develop into a sustained innovation network supporting market access, investment, technology collaboration and joint innovation between the two startup ecosystems.

#### **12.2.4 Create an India–Spain Innovation Forum**

Establish an annual India–Spain Innovation Forum bringing together startups, universities, research institutions, corporations, investors, technology providers and relevant government agencies from both countries. The forum should provide a structured platform for exchanging ideas, showcasing emerging technologies, identifying areas of mutual interest and developing collaborative opportunities. Rather than limiting the initiative to business networking, the forum should focus on converting connections into joint innovation, technology partnerships, pilot projects and commercialisation opportunities, helping Indian and Spanish organisations develop solutions that can be scaled across both markets.

#### **12.2.5 Build Sector-Specific India–Spain Working Groups**

Establish permanent sector-specific working groups for priority industries to create a continuous mechanism for dialogue, business coordination and opportunity development between Indian and Spanish stakeholders. Potential groups could include the India–Spain Renewable Energy Working Group, Automotive & EV Working Group, Food & Agriculture Working Group, Technology Working Group, Aerospace Working Group, Pharmaceutical Working Group and SME Working Group. Each group could bring together relevant companies, industry associations, experts, institutions and other stakeholders from both countries to identify sector-specific opportunities and address practical business challenges.

Each working group should meet periodically and maintain a structured programme of activities, including market discussions, stakeholder consultations, business matchmaking and identification of potential projects or partnerships. At the end of each year, every group should prepare an Annual Action Plan outlining priority opportunities, proposed initiatives, key stakeholders, expected outcomes and follow-up activities. This would provide continuity to India–Spain sector cooperation and ensure that engagement moves beyond individual events towards sustained, measurable business and institutional collaboration.

#### **12.2.6 Strengthen Air-Cargo and Logistics Cooperation**

Undertake a commercial feasibility and industry consultation study to assess the potential for stronger air-cargo and logistics connections between major Indian and Spanish business hubs. The study could examine connectivity between Delhi, Mumbai and Bengaluru on the Indian side and major Spanish logistics hubs such as Madrid and Barcelona.

Rather than immediately advocating for a dedicated air-cargo corridor, the initial objective should be to understand existing demand, infrastructure, commercial viability and the requirements of exporters, importers, logistics companies and airlines.

The study should assess cargo volumes, high-value products, perishables, pharmaceuticals, electronics and automotive components, along with freight economics, available airline capacity and the efficiency of customs and cargo-handling processes. It should also identify existing logistics gaps, potential routes, seasonal demand and opportunities for improving supply-chain efficiency. The findings could help India determine whether stronger direct or connecting air-cargo services are commercially justified and identify practical measures for improving India–Spain logistics connectivity.

Based on the findings, India could facilitate discussions among airlines, airports, freight forwarders, exporters, importers, logistics providers and relevant government agencies to explore commercially viable solutions. Over time, stronger logistics connectivity could support higher-value trade, faster delivery of time-sensitive products and deeper integration between Indian and Spanish supply chains.

#### **12.2.7 Launch an India–Spain Food & Agriculture Forum**

Launch an India–Spain Food & Agriculture Forum to strengthen commercial cooperation between Indian producers, food businesses and agricultural enterprises and Spanish importers, distributors, retailers and technology providers. The forum could cover a wide range of opportunities including processed food, spices, tea, coffee, fruits, vegetables, seafood, food technology, packaging, cold-chain solutions and agricultural machinery.

Through organised buyer-seller meetings, business delegations and participation in relevant food and agriculture exhibitions, India can facilitate direct connections between Indian producers and Spanish buyers, creating opportunities for exports, distribution partnerships, technology collaboration and investment while supporting greater market access for Indian food and agriculture businesses.

#### **12.2.8 Develop an EU Compliance Support Programme**

Since Spain is part of the European Union Single Market, Indian companies seeking to export products to Spain need to understand and comply with the relevant EU-level requirements applicable to their specific products. India could establish an EU Compliance Support Programme to help Indian exporters navigate these requirements before entering the Spanish market.

The programme could provide practical guidance on product standards, conformity assessment, CE marking where applicable, chemical compliance, food safety, packaging, sustainability requirements, documentation and labelling, helping businesses identify potential compliance requirements at an early stage.

The programme should also connect Indian exporters with qualified technical, regulatory and compliance experts who can provide product-specific guidance and professional support. CCI India would primarily act as a facilitator, helping businesses identify the appropriate specialists rather than directly providing regulated technical or legal advice. Such a programme could reduce compliance-related uncertainties, minimise avoidable delays and help Indian companies become better prepared for accessing not only Spain but also the wider European market.

### **12.2.9 Establish an India–Spain Annual Business Summit**

After sufficient institutional relationships and business networks have been established, India could organise an annual India–Spain Business Summit as a flagship bilateral business event, with the summit alternating between India and Spain. The event would provide a high-level platform for government representatives, business leaders, investors, startups, industry associations and other stakeholders to discuss emerging opportunities and strengthen economic cooperation. Alternating the location between the two countries would encourage greater participation from businesses and institutions on both sides and create a recurring platform for bilateral engagement.

The summit could follow a structured format beginning with Government Dialogue and a CEO Forum, followed by sector-specific discussions covering priority industries and emerging areas of cooperation. This could be followed by B2B meetings, a Startup Showcase and an Investment Roundtable, giving participants opportunities to identify commercial partnerships, investment projects and technology collaborations. The event could also provide a platform for announcing MoUs and strategic business partnerships that emerge from the discussions.

A dedicated follow-up mechanism should be established after each summit to track the progress of business leads, investment discussions, partnership proposals and announced agreements. India could maintain regular communication with participating companies and institutions and monitor key outcomes until they progress towards concrete commercial activity. A designated coordination team could periodically review the status of each opportunity, identify bottlenecks and facilitate communication between relevant stakeholders. This would ensure that the momentum generated through the summit is sustained and translated into measurable trade, investment and partnership outcomes.

This would ensure that the Annual Business Summit becomes a platform for generating long-term business relationships and measurable economic outcomes, rather than functioning only as a one-day networking event.

## 12.3 LONG-TERM RECOMMENDATIONS

### 12.3.1 Institutionalise a Permanent “India–Spain Business Council”

Explore establishing a permanent India–Spain Business Council that brings together Indian and Spanish companies, chambers of commerce, industry associations, investors, government institutions, startups and universities. The Council could serve as a strategic umbrella for long-term bilateral business cooperation, providing a continuous platform for dialogue, stakeholder coordination, business matchmaking, investment discussions and identification of emerging opportunities. Unlike individual events or delegations, the Council could maintain an ongoing institutional relationship between the two business ecosystems and provide continuity to initiatives developed under the broader India–Spain cooperation framework.

### 12.3.2 Develop a Joint Venture Facilitation Programme

Establish a pipeline-based Joint Venture Facilitation Programme rather than setting an arbitrary numerical target for joint ventures. The programme could focus on sectors with strong potential for complementary capabilities between India and Spain, including defence and aerospace, renewable energy, green hydrogen, automotive, EV components, advanced manufacturing, digital technology, food processing and infrastructure.

India could identify potential opportunities and systematically move them through a structured process of Opportunity Identification → Partner Screening → Due Diligence → B2B Engagement → Project Development → Financing → JV Formation → Scale-up. A realistic target for joint ventures should be established after the first two years, once sufficient pipeline and market data are available to assess the actual level of demand and conversion potential.

### 12.3.3 Explore a Cross-Border SME Investment Platform

Explore the feasibility of developing a Cross-Border India–Spain SME Investment Platform designed to connect promising businesses with suitable sources of capital and strategic investment. The platform could bring together angel investors, family offices, venture capital funds, private equity firms, strategic corporate investors and development finance institutions interested in supporting companies with demonstrable cross-border expansion potential. It could prioritise high-growth sectors such as renewable energy, advanced manufacturing, technology, food processing, automotive, healthcare and digital services, creating a focused pipeline of investment-ready businesses.

In addition to connecting businesses with investors, the platform could facilitate investor introductions, business presentations, project evaluation and cross-border partnership discussions. Any investment fund or financial structure associated with the platform would, however, require appropriate financial, legal and regulatory assessment before implementation.

#### **12.3.4. Build a Joint Green Technology Cooperation Platform**

Develop a Joint Green Technology Cooperation Platform to strengthen commercial and technological cooperation between Indian and Spanish organisations in the rapidly developing green economy. Potential areas of cooperation could include renewable energy, green hydrogen, energy storage, smart grids, energy efficiency, sustainable mobility, circular economy solutions and industrial decarbonisation. CCI India could act as a business connector between Spanish technology providers, Indian industrial users, project developers, investors and other relevant stakeholders, helping identify opportunities for technology partnerships, pilot projects, investment and commercial deployment. The platform could provide a structured mechanism for moving from discussions around sustainability towards practical business and industrial cooperation.

#### **12.3.5 Create a Long-Term India–Spain Industrial Partnership Programme**

Work towards developing a Long-Term India–Spain Industrial Partnership Programme focused on building deeper supply-chain relationships rather than relying primarily on one-time trade transactions. The programme could promote integrated industrial cooperation across several strategic value chains. In the automotive sector, opportunities could extend from automotive components and EVs to batteries, electronics and industrial automation. In the energy sector, cooperation could progress from renewable energy to green hydrogen, energy storage and industrial decarbonisation.

Aerospace cooperation could connect components, engineering and advanced manufacturing capabilities, while the food sector could develop linkages across food processing, packaging, cold-chain infrastructure and distribution. Such an approach would encourage sustained industrial relationships, technology cooperation, investment and integration into international supply chains. The platform could also identify companies with strong export potential, innovative technologies and scalable business models suitable for international expansion. Sector-specific investment opportunities could be presented through curated investor briefings, pitch sessions and targeted business meetings. This approach would help channel capital towards commercially viable projects while strengthening India–Spain investment and technology linkages.

### 12.3.6 Establish a Bilateral Trade Growth Programme

Establish a long-term Bilateral Trade Growth Programme aimed at substantially expanding India–Spain trade by 2030. The previously proposed US\$15 billion bilateral trade target by 2030 may be retained as an aspirational India strategic target; however, it should not be presented as an official government target unless formally adopted by the relevant authorities. The programme should instead establish annual milestones based on verified baseline trade data and regularly assess progress against measurable business outcomes.

The performance framework should monitor indicators such as the number of new exporters and importers entering the bilateral market, new Spanish buyers and Indian suppliers identified, investment projects initiated, business partnerships established, joint ventures developed, trade delegations organised and B2B meetings conducted. Most importantly, India should track the conversion of these activities into actual commercial transactions, ensuring that the programme measures not only the number of meetings or connections created but also the tangible economic outcomes generated. This approach would provide a practical basis for evaluating progress and adjusting the India–Spain trade strategy over time.

## 12.4 PROPOSED INDIA PERFORMANCE FRAMEWORK

To ensure that the recommendations produce measurable results, establish a monitoring framework.

| Area              | Short Term                 | Medium Term         | Long Term                         |
|-------------------|----------------------------|---------------------|-----------------------------------|
| Spain Desk        | Establish                  | Expand              | Institutionalise                  |
| Business database | Build                      | Continuously expand | Integrated bilateral platform     |
| B2B meetings      | Pilot                      | Regular             | Large-scale                       |
| Delegations       | Initiate                   | 2+ annually         | Institutionalised programme       |
| SME cooperation   | Survey                     | SME Connect         | Permanent SME network             |
| Startups          | Mapping                    | Startup Bridge      | Joint innovation ecosystem        |
| Investment        | Identify projects          | Facilitate projects | Institutional investment platform |
| Sector forums     | Establish priority sectors | Working groups      | Permanent sector councils         |

| Area                    | Short Term          | Medium Term             | Long Term                       |
|-------------------------|---------------------|-------------------------|---------------------------------|
| Trade promotion         | Market intelligence | Buyer-seller programmes | Long-term trade growth strategy |
| Institutional relations | Initial MoUs        | Expand network          | Business Council                |

## 12.5 PRIORITY ACTION MATRIX

Prioritise initiatives according to impact, feasibility and time required.

| Initiative                           | Impact      | Feasibility | Priority    |
|--------------------------------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|
| Spain Desk                           | High        | High        | Immediate   |
| MSME barrier survey                  | High        | High        | Immediate   |
| Business database                    | High        | High        | Immediate   |
| Spanish chamber partnerships         | High        | Medium      | High        |
| Export-readiness programme           | High        | High        | High        |
| SME Connect platform                 | High        | Medium      | High        |
| Renewable Energy Delegation          | High        | High        | High        |
| Automotive/EV Delegation             | High        | High        | High        |
| Startup Bridge                       | Medium–High | Medium      | Medium      |
| Investment Facilitation Programme    | High        | Medium      | High        |
| Annual Business Summit               | High        | Medium      | Medium–High |
| India–Spain Business Council         | Very High   | Medium      | Long Term   |
| Cross-border SME investment platform | High        | Low–Medium  | Long Term   |
| Bilateral industrial partnerships    | Very High   | Medium      | Long Term   |

## 12.6 OVERALL STRATEGIC DIRECTION

The recommended India approach for strengthening India–Spain economic cooperation should be developed as a long-term, structured and progressive strategy rather than as a collection of individual trade promotion activities. The overall approach can evolve through three interconnected stages: Connect, Facilitate and Scale.

Each stage should build upon the outcomes of the previous stage, allowing India to gradually develop the knowledge, relationships, business networks and institutional mechanisms required to support sustained economic engagement between India and Spain.

### **Stage 1 Connect: Building the Knowledge and Relationship Infrastructure**

The first stage should focus on Connect, which represents the foundation of the entire India–Spain business cooperation framework. Before businesses can successfully enter a new market, they require reliable information about market conditions, industries, regulations, companies, investment opportunities and potential partners. India should therefore prioritise research, stakeholder mapping and institutional outreach during this stage. The objective should be to develop a comprehensive understanding of Spain's business ecosystem while simultaneously identifying Indian companies and institutions that have the capabilities or interest to participate in bilateral cooperation.

Research should cover Spain's major industries, regional business clusters, infrastructure, investment environment, trade patterns, regulatory requirements and emerging commercial opportunities. At the same time, India should map Spanish companies, industry associations, chambers of commerce, investors, technology providers, universities, startups and relevant government and institutional stakeholders. This information can gradually be organised into a structured India–Spain business intelligence database that can support future matchmaking and delegation planning.

Institutional outreach should form another important part of the Connect stage. India should develop relationships with relevant Spanish chambers, industry associations, business organisations, universities, innovation institutions and other ecosystem partners.

These relationships can create channels for information exchange, business introductions and joint programmes. The objective should be to establish a credible institutional network through which Indian businesses can access relevant Spanish stakeholders without having to navigate the market entirely on their own.

The Connect stage should ultimately create a strong knowledge and relationship infrastructure for bilateral cooperation. By the end of this stage, India should have a clearer understanding of where the strongest opportunities exist, which Spanish organisations can support Indian businesses, which Indian sectors have the greatest potential and where institutional partnerships can generate practical results. This foundation would then allow India to move from information and relationship building towards active business facilitation.

## **Stage 2 Facilitate: Converting Relationships into Commercial Opportunities**

The second stage should focus on Facilitate, with the objective of converting the relationships and information developed during the Connect stage into practical commercial opportunities. At this stage, India should move beyond simply providing market information and begin actively connecting Indian and Spanish companies through structured business activities. This stage should include targeted B2B meetings, sector-specific business forums, buyer–seller interactions, investment discussions and curated matchmaking programmes. Regular follow-up can help businesses move from initial introductions towards partnerships, contracts, joint ventures and investment opportunities.

Business delegations can play an important role in this stage, particularly when they are organised around clearly identified sectors and commercial objectives. Instead of organising general-purpose delegations, India should focus on priority areas such as renewable energy, automotive and EVs, advanced manufacturing, food and agriculture, technology, pharmaceuticals, aerospace and other sectors where there is evidence of bilateral business potential. Each delegation should be supported by advance stakeholder mapping, pre-arranged meetings and clearly defined business objectives.

B2B matchmaking should become a central component of the Facilitate stage. India can identify potential buyers, suppliers, distributors, technology providers, investors and strategic partners based on the requirements of participating businesses. This can be supported through the proposed India–Spain SME Connect platform, sector-specific working groups and the India Spain Desk. The emphasis should be on creating relevant connections rather than simply maximising the number of meetings.

Investment facilitation should operate alongside trade promotion. Indian companies considering expansion into Spain should be able to access information about suitable regions, industrial clusters, infrastructure, potential partners and relevant professional support. Similarly, Spanish companies exploring India should be connected with Indian business opportunities, investment projects and potential local partners. India can support this process by facilitating introductions, organising investor meetings and connecting companies with appropriate legal, regulatory and professional advisers.

The Facilitate stage should also include structured follow-up. A business introduction has limited value if there is no mechanism for continuing the conversation after the meeting or delegation. CCI India should therefore maintain a follow-up system to track business enquiries, partnership discussions, investment proposals, buyer-supplier relationships and other opportunities emerging from its programmes. This would allow the organisation to identify which activities are producing meaningful outcomes and where additional intervention may be required.

### **Stage 3 Scale: Building Sustained Economic Partnerships**

The third stage should focus on Scale, representing the transition from individual business interactions towards deeper and more sustained economic partnerships. Once a strong network of companies, institutions and investors has been developed, India can begin facilitating more complex forms of cooperation such as joint ventures, technology partnerships, strategic investments, innovation projects and long-term industrial relationships.

Joint ventures could become particularly relevant in sectors where Indian and Spanish capabilities are complementary. Potential areas could include renewable energy, green hydrogen, automotive and EV components, aerospace, advanced manufacturing, digital technologies, food processing and infrastructure. India should adopt a pipeline-based approach, beginning with opportunity identification and partner screening before progressing towards due diligence, B2B engagement, project development, financing and eventual joint venture formation.

Innovation should also become a major pillar of the Scale stage. The proposed India–Spain Startup Bridge and India–Spain Innovation Forum can create channels for collaboration between startups, universities, research institutions, investors and corporations. The objective should be to move from simple networking towards pilot projects, technology demonstrations, joint development and commercialisation. This can help establish new areas of cooperation beyond traditional trade and create opportunities in emerging industries.

Investment cooperation should similarly move towards a more mature stage. As the number of participating companies and investment opportunities increases, CCI India could develop more structured mechanisms for connecting investors with cross-border projects. This could eventually include an India–Spain investment network, SME investment facilitation and sector-specific investment platforms, subject to appropriate financial, legal and regulatory requirements.

The Scale stage should therefore focus on creating long-term institutional platforms that remain active even when individual events or delegations have concluded. A permanent India–Spain Business Council, sector working groups, annual business summits and long-term industrial partnership programmes could provide the institutional structure required for sustained cooperation.

### 12.6.1 Creating a Trusted Business Bridge Between India and Spain

The ultimate objective of this three-stage approach should be to establish CCI India as a trusted business bridge between India and Spain. This role would extend beyond simply organising meetings or trade missions. India should aim to help businesses navigate the complete journey from understanding the market to identifying opportunities, finding partners, entering into discussions, developing commercial relationships and expanding their operations.

For companies, this could mean providing access to reliable information about Spain, identifying potential Spanish buyers and partners, explaining market-entry considerations and facilitating introductions to relevant institutions. For Spanish businesses, the same platform could provide access to Indian suppliers, investors, manufacturers, technology companies, startups and potential market opportunities. This two-way approach would ensure that the initiative is positioned as a genuine bilateral business platform rather than an India-only export promotion mechanism.

### 12.6.2 Strategic Recommendation

Avoid positioning the India–Spain initiative simply as another trade delegation programme. Delegations are valuable, but they should form only one component of a much broader and continuously operating business ecosystem. A more effective model would be the creation of a year-round India–Spain Business Cooperation Platform capable of supporting businesses before, during and after trade missions, investment visits and business meetings.

The first pillar of this platform should be Market Intelligence. Businesses require reliable and regularly updated information before making decisions about international expansion. CCI India can provide sector intelligence, regional opportunity mapping, company information, market-entry guidance and information on relevant trade and investment developments. This would help businesses identify opportunities and make more informed decisions before committing resources to the Spanish market.

The second pillar should be Business Matchmaking. Once opportunities have been identified, businesses need access to suitable buyers, suppliers, distributors, technology partners, investors and strategic partners. CCI India can use its stakeholder database, institutional relationships, sector working groups and digital platforms to create targeted introductions. The objective should be quality-driven matchmaking based on actual business requirements rather than generic networking.

The third pillar should be Delegations and Business Missions. Delegations should provide companies with direct exposure to the Spanish market and allow them to meet government institutions, industry leaders, potential partners and investors. However, every delegation should be supported by pre-mission research, targeted meeting schedules and post-mission follow-up so that the value of the programme extends well beyond the physical visit.

The fourth pillar should be Investment Facilitation. CCI India can help identify investment opportunities, connect investors with potential projects and facilitate introductions between Indian and Spanish companies. This should cover both directions of investment, supporting Spanish companies interested in India as well as Indian companies exploring Spain as a market, investment destination or potential gateway to wider European opportunities.

The fifth pillar should be SME Support. Small and medium-sized businesses may face greater challenges when entering an international market because they often have limited resources, market information and international networks. Dedicated programmes such as India–Spain SME Connect, export-readiness support, buyer identification and regulatory orientation can help bring more SMEs into the bilateral business ecosystem.

The sixth pillar should be Startup Cooperation. The India–Spain Startup Bridge can create opportunities for entrepreneurs, technology companies, accelerators, investors and innovation institutions to work together. Cooperation could focus on emerging sectors such as artificial intelligence, climate technology, clean technology, agricultural technology, healthcare technology, logistics technology and EV technology. Over time, this can support joint innovation, pilot projects, technology transfer and commercialisation.

The seventh pillar should be Sector Forums and Working Groups. Permanent or recurring working groups can provide continuity within priority industries and ensure that sector-specific opportunities and challenges are discussed regularly. Renewable energy, automotive and EVs, food and agriculture, technology, aerospace, pharmaceuticals and SMEs can each have dedicated mechanisms for stakeholder engagement and annual action planning.

The eighth pillar should be Regulatory Orientation. Indian companies entering Spain need to understand the applicable EU and Spanish regulatory environment. CCI India can help businesses identify relevant requirements and connect them with qualified technical, legal and regulatory professionals. This would allow companies to address compliance considerations before entering the market and reduce avoidable delays or misunderstandings.

The ninth and final pillar should be Long-Term Partnership Development. The ultimate purpose of the platform should be to convert individual contacts into sustained commercial relationships. This could include joint ventures, strategic investments, technology partnerships, industrial supply-chain cooperation, research collaboration and institutional partnerships. Long-term relationships are more likely to generate lasting economic value than isolated transactions.

### 12.6.3 An Integrated Year-Round Business Cooperation Model

The strength of this proposed model lies in its ability to create value at every stage of the business relationship. Before a trade mission, CCI India can provide market intelligence, identify potential partners, conduct sector research and prepare companies for market entry. During a trade mission, it can facilitate government meetings, industry interactions, B2B meetings, investment discussions and site visits. After the mission, it can monitor business leads, facilitate follow-up meetings, support partnership discussions and help companies remain connected with relevant stakeholders.

This creates a continuous cycle of Research → Connect → Match → Engage → Facilitate → Follow Up → Scale. Instead of treating each delegation, summit or B2B meeting as a standalone activity, India can connect all these activities into a single strategic framework. The same company that enters the network through a business forum could later participate in a delegation, identify a Spanish partner through SME Connect, explore an investment opportunity and eventually develop a joint venture or long-term supply-chain relationship.

Such a model can also provide India with a stronger basis for measuring its impact. Performance should not be assessed only through the number of events organised or participants attending programmes. More meaningful indicators would include new exporters and importers, verified business connections, qualified B2B meetings, buyer and supplier relationships, investment leads, partnerships, technology collaborations, joint ventures and commercial transactions generated through the platform.

### 12.6.4 Long-Term Institutional Vision

Over time, the India–Spain Business Cooperation Platform could become a permanent institutional mechanism supporting bilateral economic engagement throughout the year. The India Spain Desk could act as the operational centre, while the proposed India–Spain Business Council could provide strategic direction. Sector working groups could address industry-specific priorities, the SME Connect platform could support digital matchmaking, the Startup Bridge could strengthen innovation cooperation and annual summits and delegations could provide high-level visibility and direct engagement.

The platform could also maintain a structured database of verified businesses, investors, technology providers, institutions and sector opportunities in both countries. This would enable CCI India to continuously identify emerging opportunities and connect suitable stakeholders based on sector, business requirements and investment interests.

The long-term vision should therefore be to create an ecosystem in which information leads to connections, connections lead to meetings, meetings lead to opportunities, opportunities lead to partnerships and partnerships lead to sustained economic activity. This would give India a distinctive and practical role in India–Spain economic cooperation while creating a mechanism that can continuously evolve as business opportunities and market conditions change.

A continuous feedback and monitoring mechanism could further help assess the effectiveness of the platform and identify areas requiring greater institutional support. Regular reviews of trade leads, investment discussions, partnerships and sector-level outcomes would allow the framework to remain responsive to changing market conditions.

Ultimately, the proposed strategy should position India not merely as an organiser of trade missions, but as a long-term facilitator, connector and institutional bridge between the Indian and Spanish business communities. By combining market intelligence, matchmaking, delegations, investment facilitation, SME support, startup cooperation, sector engagement, regulatory orientation and long-term partnership development, India can create a comprehensive framework capable of supporting deeper trade, investment, innovation and industrial cooperation between the two countries.

Over the longer term, this approach can create a self-sustaining network of institutions and businesses that continues to generate opportunities beyond individual programmes and events. It can strengthen trust between the two business communities while establishing a practical foundation for sustained India–Spain economic cooperation.

The platform could also develop a strong knowledge-sharing function by regularly publishing India–Spain sector reports, market opportunity briefs, regulatory updates and business intelligence. These resources could help companies make informed decisions while giving policymakers and industry stakeholders a clearer understanding of emerging areas for bilateral cooperation.

In the longer term, the development of strategic sector partnerships involving industry associations, research institutions, universities, investors and technology organisations from both countries. Such collaborations could support innovation, skills development, technology transfer and joint research, helping India–Spain economic cooperation expand beyond traditional trade into higher-value and knowledge-driven sectors.

## 13. CONCLUSION

The India–Spain commercial relationship is entering an important phase of opportunity and transformation. India’s growing manufacturing, infrastructure, digital and innovation capabilities complement Spain’s strengths in industrial technology, renewable energy, advanced manufacturing and European market connectivity. This creates scope to move beyond conventional trade towards deeper cooperation in investment, technology, manufacturing, innovation and long-term business partnerships.

Spain offers Indian businesses not only a domestic market but also an important platform within the European business environment. Its industrial clusters, ports, logistics networks and internationally active companies create opportunities across renewable energy, automotive and EVs, aerospace, food and agriculture, digital technology and advanced manufacturing. At the same time, Indian companies can bring scale, competitive manufacturing, digital expertise, entrepreneurial capabilities and access to one of the world’s major growth markets.

For Indian MSMEs and emerging businesses, however, successful entry into Spain requires a clear understanding of EU regulations, product compliance, documentation, logistics, packaging, labelling and local business practices. This creates an important role for CCI India in providing market intelligence, export-readiness support, business matchmaking, regulatory orientation and connections with credible local professionals. CCI India can therefore help convert market opportunities into practical business relationships and commercial outcomes.

The proposed Connect → Facilitate → Scale approach provides a structured framework for long-term cooperation. CCI India can first build knowledge and institutional relationships, then facilitate B2B meetings, trade opportunities, investment discussions and sector engagements, and finally support successful relationships through joint ventures, technology partnerships, innovation projects and long-term industrial cooperation. A year-round India–Spain Business Cooperation Platform, supported by a dedicated Spain Desk, can provide continuity beyond individual delegations and events.

Ultimately, India–Spain relations should be viewed not simply as a conventional trade relationship, but as an opportunity to build a long-term economic partnership. Stronger cooperation in renewable energy, automotive and EVs, aerospace, food and agriculture, digital technology, pharmaceuticals and advanced manufacturing can create value for businesses in both countries and strengthen international supply chains. The central message is clear: the future of India–Spain economic relations should not be limited to buying and selling; it should focus on building together connecting markets, combining capabilities and creating sustainable opportunities for the future.

# THANK YOU

CCI India sincerely thanks Your Excellency for the warm hospitality and gracious interaction with our team. We greatly value the opportunity to discuss strengthening India-Spain bilateral trade and economic relations and look forward to deepening cooperation, expanding business engagement, and creating new avenues for trade, investment, and mutually beneficial partnerships between the two countries.



# *India & Spain: A Partnership Rooted in Trust, Growing Towards Opportunity*



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